ACTIVITY 6

Build a Root-Cause and Corrective-Action Plan

ISO 9001 Quality Management System (QMS) Internal Auditor Training
TGS-2023039341 · K3 · A3 · LO3 · 75 minutes

Objective

Propose risk-based corrective actions that address verified causes and include effectiveness measures.

Scenario

Three work orders were produced using an obsolete drawing revision. The affected product is contained, but the organisation must determine why the control failed and prevent recurrence without assuming that 'operator error' is the root cause.

Materials

- Confirmed finding and process evidence from Activity 5
- Change-flow timeline and role information
- Corrective-action workbook with 5 Whys and cause-validation fields

Activity questions

- What immediate correction and containment protect the customer now?
- Which causal paths are supported by evidence, and which are assumptions?
- How do the proposed actions address the system cause rather than only the symptom?
- What measure and time horizon will demonstrate effectiveness?

Required evidence

- Containment record
- Cause-analysis worksheet
- Corrective-action plan
- Risk review
- Effectiveness check

Detailed Procedure

1. Restate the nonconformity and identify the affected outputs, customers, records and time period.

2. Define immediate correction and containment. Assign an owner and confirm how affected product or service will be controlled.

3. Map the event timeline from receipt of the revised drawing to discovery of the obsolete revision.

4. Use 5 Whys or fishbone categories to generate possible causes across method, people, technology, information, environment and management controls.

5. Test each possible cause against evidence. Mark unsupported causes for further investigation rather than treating them as fact.

6. Select the verified root and contributing causes and document why they explain the failure mechanism.

7. Design corrective actions that remove or control those causes. Include procedure, system, competence and monitoring changes only where evidence supports them.

8. Assess risks and unintended consequences of each proposed action before implementation.

9. Define owner, resources, due date and completion evidence for every action.

10. Define an effectiveness check with a metric, sample, acceptance criterion and review date; include escalation if ineffective.

Acceptance Check

The plan distinguishes correction from corrective action, validates causes with evidence, assigns accountable actions and defines an objective effectiveness test.

Learner completion checklist

Done	Evidence / output	Reviewer comment
■	Containment record	
■	Cause-analysis worksheet	
■	Corrective-action plan	
■	Risk review	
■	Effectiveness check	